

MINTEL



2026 Global Food & Drink Predictions

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Turning today's signals into tomorrow's strategies: 2026 Global Food & Drink Predictions

Our 2026 Global Food and Drink Predictions go beyond short-term trends, delivering predictive intelligence to map the future trends shaping the food and drink industry **through 2030 and beyond.**

Global challenges like climate change, supply chain disruptions, and chronic health impacts are complicating consumers' daily lives. For food and drink brands, the

opportunity lies in fostering resilience by showing they, too, are navigating these issues while **offering solutions that empower consumers to endure and thrive amidst adversity.**

From **enhanced dietary diversity**, to **trust in traditional ingredients**, to **purposeful multisensory food and drink products**. These predictive insights offer clarity on long-term consumer behaviours, empowering you to anticipate change, inspire action and lead your brand into the future.

The 2026 Global Food & Drink Predictions are:

1. “Maxxing” Out, Diversity In

Consumers will move past the viral advice and goal of ‘maxxing’ their daily protein or fiber intake, to adopt inclusive diets that celebrate the functional benefits of incorporating a diverse variety of ingredients each week to fortify and sustain their long-term health.

2. Retro Rejuvenation

Products that are rooted in trusted and practical traditions will help ease consumers’ sense of lack of control in the modern world. Brands that ground themselves in heritage ingredients and ancient medicines will be respected as cultural custodians, combining taste with long histories of functional benefits.

3. Intentionally Sensory

2026 will see multisensory products maturing from whimsical novelties to purposeful creations that intensify consumers’ emotional connections with better-for-you food by combining taste, visuals, textures, and aromas in a pleasing way.

Ready to shape the future of your industry?

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Once you've read the Predictions... what's next?

That's where [Mintel Consulting](#) comes in. We'll help you turn Mintel's Predictions into tailored strategies for your brand—translating behavioural analysis into actionable opportunities that drive market growth, fuel consumer demand, and sharpen your innovation strategy.

Already a client? [Log in](#) to download the full Predictive Insights and connect with your account manager.

Want the full picture? Download the full [2026 Prediction Insights](#) series for expert analysis and strategic recommendations to make smarter, faster decisions.

Did you know... Fibre is the next multi-million-dollar opportunity in Food & Drink, and Mintel Consultants can help you capitalise on it. Discover how shifting consumer demand is putting fibre in the spotlight. Connect with our Consultants about our latest insight '[Unlock Millions in Untapped Fibre Category Growth](#),' and let our Consultants help you turn this trend into your next big win.

Meet the experts

Jenny Zegler

Director of Insights | Food & Drink

Jenny Zegler has 18 years of experience covering the beverage and food industry. She has led the creation of Mintel's Global Food & Drink Trends since 2015 and regularly shares insights with Mintel clients, in the media, and at conferences in the US and around the world.

Alex Beckett

Senior Director | Food & Drink

Alex Beckett thrives in using Mintel's vast data resources to create thought-provoking and fresh insight stories for clients. Also, his expertise and presentations on beverages are highly sought-after around the world.

Alice Pilkington

Principle Analyst | Food & Drink

Alice combines a flair for uncovering exciting, data-driven consumer insights with a passion for food that stems from her previous career as a cookery school teacher for Jamie Oliver and Gordon Ramsay. She has delighted audiences around the world with her enthusiastic and thought-provoking presentations.

Dillan Morar

Senior Insights Consultant | Black Swan Data

Dillan specialises in the Food & Drink categories, bringing extensive experience in leveraging social data and predictive analytics to uncover actionable insights for leading global brands.

Complete the form to download Mintel's Predictive Insights

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Our methodology

Built on the seven Mintel Trend Drivers—Wellbeing, Surroundings, Technology, Rights, Identity, Value, and Experiences—our methodology supports the fluid acceleration or deceleration of a trend according to the reality of individual markets. This ensures we remain adaptive, reactive to change and focused on the future.

Our predictions are built on a foundation of robust data and expert analysis. This unmatched combination ensures that what you read and discover is meaningful,

actionable and provides the clarity you need to move beyond reacting to the future and to start shaping it.

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